

Telemetry Controller (Ipha-C Protocol related)

Making it a heavy, functional piece of military hardware raises the stakes significantly. It turns the object from a mere trinket into a loaded gun, and perfectly justifies why Ipha-c's core protocol is obsessing over it.

Here is how we integrate a controller-sized piece of hardware into a 5-year-old body-horror crime.

The Artifact: The "Telemetry Brick"

It isn't jewelry; it's a ruggedized **Tactical Override Node**. Picture something the size and weight of an industrial crane controller or an arcade fight stick. It has dead-man switches, a heavy interface cable, and a decaying isotope battery.

Forty years ago, this controller was used to manually command something massive—a submerged automated torpedo battery, a grid of deep-water mines, or the blast doors of a sunken wartime bunker. Ipha-c's protocol demands she secure this controller to either arm or scuttle that massive, dormant asset.

How It Became Part of the Graft

A Sump scavenger didn't keep the controller because it looked valuable; they kept it because of the battery.

The Scavenger's Rig: The scavenger dragged this heavy controller out of the mud and physically bolted it to the chest plate of their diving suit, hotwiring its 40-year-old battery to power their plasma cutters and oxygen scrubbers.

The Vigilante's Ballast: When the vigilante captured this scavenger five years ago, they didn't care about the metal box on the victim's chest. The vigilante needed to make sure the grafted body didn't immediately float to the surface and get discovered too quickly. They needed weight.

The vigilante used the heavy military controller as a literal **ballast**. They laid a massive sea creature—like a deep-trench crustacean or a heavy cluster of abyssal tube worms—directly *over* the controller, sewing the biological mass through the scavenger's flesh and around the hardware. The victim was dropped into the ocean, perfectly weighted to drift in the dark, freezing thermocline layer for years, a horrifying hybrid of flesh, sea life, and military steel.

The Trigger (Present Day)

For five years, the heavy organic matter of the graft muffled the controller's signal. But the ocean is corrosive.

Recently, the sea creature stitched over the controller finally died and rotted away, or the body bumped into a jagged reef that tore the flesh open. The heavy metal casing of the Telemetry Brick was exposed to the open water, and its emergency beacon finally sent out a weak, degraded ping.

The moment Ipha-c wakes up and detects that ping, the Skinner Box traps Sa. She cannot interface with the massive wartime hardware without that controller, so she relentlessly drives Sa to fetch it.

Sa now has to track a rotting, drifting corpse through the dark waters of the metropolis. Worse, when he finds it, he will instantly recognize the vigilante's distinct "grafting" method—forcing him to confront the exact cold case he arrogantly botched five years ago.

ultimate insult to a serial killer's ego.

You spend years crafting this macabre, terrifying reputation. You view yourself as a terrifying visionary of the deep sea. You think you've successfully outsmarted the authorities, survived a warehouse explosion, and vanished into local myth as a terrifying boogeyman.

Then your front door gets kicked off its hinges by a dead-eyed, heavily armed, muscled twink who is visibly tweaking from dopamine withdrawal, accompanied by glitched military AI that doesn't even care what those are all about—just an "environmental obstacle" standing between it and its telemetry brick.